

Twelfth Night

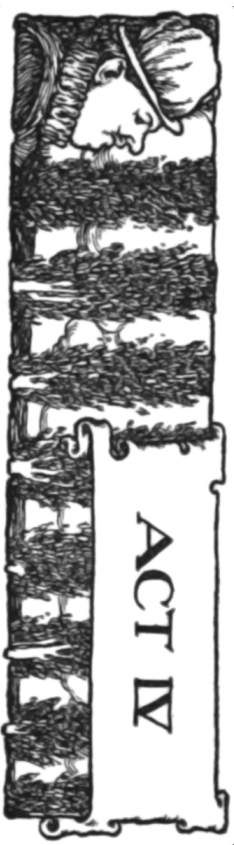
FABIAN

Come, let's see the event.

TOBY

I dare lay any money 'twill be nothing yet.

(Exeunt omnes.)



(Exit ANTONIO, with OFFICERS)

VIOLA

Methinks his words do from such passion fly,
That he believes himself: so do not I.
Prove true, imagination, O, prove true,
That I, dear brother, be now ta'en for you!

TOBY

Come hither, knight; come hither, Fabian: we'll whisper o'er a couplet
or two of most sage saws.

(TOBY, FABIAN, and ANDREW move aside.)

VIOLA

*[Aside] He named Sebastian: I my brother know
Yet lying in my glass; even such and so
In favour was my brother, and he went
Still in this fashion, colour, ornament,
For him I imitate: O, if it prove,
Tempests are kind and salt waves fresh in love.
(Exit VIOLA.)*

TOBY

A very dishonest paltry boy, and more a coward than a hare: his
dishonesty appears in leaving his friend here in necessity and denying
him; and for his cowardship, ask Fabian.

FABIAN

A coward, a most devout coward, religious in it.

ANDREW

'Slid, I'll after him again and beat him.

TOBY

Do; cuff him soundly, but never draw thy sword.

ANDREW

An I do not,—

VIOLA

I know of none;
Nor know I you by voice or any feature:
I hate ingratitude more in a man
Than lying, vainness, babbling, drunkenness,
Or any taint of vice whose strong corruption
Inhabits our frail blood.

ANTONIO

O heavens themselves!

SECOND OFFICER

Come, sir, I pray you, go.

ANTONIO

Let me speak a little. This youth that you see here
I snatch'd one half out of the jaws of death,
Relieved him with such sanctity of love,
And to his image, which methought did promise
Most venerable worth, did I devotion.

FIRST OFFICER

What's that to us? The time goes by: away!

ANTONIO

But O how vile an idol proves this god
Thou hast, Sebastian, done good feature shame.
In nature there's no blemish but the mind;
None can be call'd deform'd but the unkind:
Virtue is beauty, but the beauteous evil
Are empty trunks o'erflowish'd by the devil.

FIRST OFFICER

The man grows mad: away with him! Come, come, sir.

ANTONIO

Lead me on.

Scene I

Before OLIVIA's house.

(Enter SEBASTIAN and FESTE.)

FESTE

Will you make me believe that I am not sent for you?

SEBASTIAN

Go to, go to, thou art a foolish fellow: Let me be clear of thee.

FESTE

Well held out, i' faith! No, I do not know you; nor I am not sent to you
by my lady, to bid you come speak with her; nor your name is not
Master Cesario; nor this is not my nose neither. Nothing that is so is so.

SEBASTIAN

I prithee, vent thy folly somewhere else: Thou know'st not me.

FESTE

Vent my folly! he has heard that word of some great man and now
applies it to a fool. Vent my folly! I am afraid this great lubber, the world,
will prove a cockney. I prithee now, ungird thy strangeness and tell me
what I shall vent to my lady: shall I vent to her that thou art coming?

SEBASTIAN

I prithee, foolish Greek, depart from me: There's money for thee: if you
tarry longer, I shall give worse payment.

FESTE

By my troth, thou hast an open hand. These wise men that give fools
money get themselves a good report—after fourteen years' purchase.

(Enter SIR ANDREW, SIR TOBY BELCH and FABIAN.)

ANDREW

(To SEBASTIAN)

Now, sir, have I met you again? there's for you.

(He strikes SEBASTIAN.)

SEBASTIAN

(Returning the blow)

Why, there's for thee, and there, and there. Are all the people mad?

TOBY

Hold, sir, or I'll throw your dagger o'er the house.

FESTE

This will I tell my lady straight: I would not be in some of your coats for two pence.

(Exit FESTE.)

TOBY

(seizing SEBASTIAN)

Come on, sir; hold!

ANDREW

Nay, let him alone: I'll go another way to work with him; I'll have an action of battery against him, if there be any law in Illyria: though I struck him first, yet it's no matter for that.

SEBASTIAN

(To TOBY)

Let go thy hand!

TOBY

Come, sir, I will not let you go. Come, my young soldier, put up your iron: you are well fleshed; come on.

SEBASTIAN

I will be free from thee.

ANTONIO

I must obey.

(To VIOLA)

This comes with seeking you:

But there's no remedy; I shall answer it.

What will you do, now my necessity

Makes me to ask you for my purse? It grieves me

Much more for what I cannot do for you

Than what befalls myself. You stand amazed;

But be of comfort.

SECOND OFFICER

Come, sir, away.

ANTONIO

(To VIOLA)

I must entreat of you some of that money.

VIOLA

What money, sir?

For the fair kindness you have show'd me here,

And, part, being prompted by your present trouble,

Out of my lean and low ability

I'll lend you something: my having is not much;

I'll make division of my present with you:

Hold, there's half my coffer.

(She offers him money.)

ANTONIO

Will you deny me now?

Is't possible that my deserts to you

Can lack persuasion? Do not tempt my misery,

Lest that it make me so unsound a man

As to upbraid you with those kindnesses

That I have done for you.

ANTONIO

One, sir, that for his love dares yet do more
Than you have heard him brag to you he will.

TOBY

Nay, if you be an undertaker, I am for you.

(They draw.)

(Enter OFFICERS.)

FABIAN

O good Sir Toby, hold! here come the officers.

TOBY

(To ANTONIO)

I'll be with you anon.

VIOLA

(To ANDREW)

Pray, sir, put your sword up, if you please.

ANDREW

Mary, will I, sir; and, for that I promised you, I'll be as good as my word:
he will bear you easily and reins well.

FIRST OFFICER

This is the man; do thy office.

SECOND OFFICER

Antonio, I arrest thee at the suit of Count Orsino.

ANTONIO

You do mistake me, sir.

FIRST OFFICER

No, sir, no joy; I know your favour well,
Though now you have no sea-cap on your head.
Take him away: he knows I know him well.

(He pulls free and draws his sword.)

What wouldst thou now? If thou dar'st tempt
me further, draw thy sword.

TOBY

What, what? Nay, then I must have an ounce or two of this malapert
blood from you.

(He draws his sword.)

(Enter OLIVIA.)

OLIVIA

Hold, Toby; on thy life I charge thee, hold!

TOBY

Madam!

OLIVIA

Will it be ever thus? Ungracious wretch,
Fit for the mountains and the barbarous caves,
Where manners ne'er were preach'd! out of my sight!
Be not offended, dear Cesario.

Rudesby, be gone!

(Exit Sir TOBY BELCH, Sir ANDREW and FABIAN.)

I prithee, gentle friend,
Let thy fair wisdom, not thy passion, sway
In this uncivil and thou unjust extent
Against thy peace. Go with me to my house,
And hear thou there how many fruitless pranks
This ruffian hath botch'd up, that thou thereby
Mayst smile at this: thou shalt not choose but go:
Do not deny. Beshrew his soul for me,
He started one poor heart of mine in thee.

SEBASTIAN

*[Aside] What relish is in this? how runs the stream?
Or I am mad, or else this is a dream:
Let fancy still my sense in Lethe steep;*

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If it be thus to dream, still let me sleep!

OLIVIA

Nay, come, I prithee; would thou'dst be ruled by me!

SEBASTIAN

Madam, I will.

OLIVIA

O, say so, and so be!

(Exeunt omnes.)



'PRAY GOD, HE KEEP HIS OATH!'

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TOBY

(To Viola)

There's no remedy, sir; he will fight with you for's oath sake: marry, he hath better bethought him of his quarrel, and he finds that now scarce to be worth talking of: therefore draw, for the supportance of his vow; he protests he will not hurt you.

VIOLA

[Aside] Pray God defend me! A little thing would make me tell them how much I lack of a man.

FABIAN

Give ground, if you see him furious.

TOBY

Come, Sir Andrew, there's no remedy; the gentleman will, for his honour's sake, have one bout with you; he cannot by the duello avoid it: but he has promised me, as he is a gentleman and a soldier, he will not hurt you. Come on; to't.

ANDREW

Pray God, he keep his oath!

VIOLA

I do assure you, 'tis against my will.

(They draw.)

(Enter ANTONIO.)

ANTONIO

(To ANDREW)

Put up your sword. If this young gentleman
Have done offence, I take the fault on me:
If you offend him, I for him defy you.

TOBY

You, sir! why, what are you?

VIOLA

I shall be much bound to you for't: I am one that had rather go with sir priest than sir knight: I care not who knows so much of my mettle.

(Exeunt VIOLA and FABIAN.)

(Re-enter Sir TOBY BELCH, with Sir ANDREW.)

TOBY

Why, man, he's a very devil; I have not seen such a frago. I had a pass with him, rapier, scabard and all, and he gives me the stuck in with such a mortal motion, that it is inevitable; and on the answer, he pays you as surely as your feet hit the ground they step on. They say he has been fencer to the Sophy.

ANDREW

Pox on't, I'll not meddle with him.

TOBY

Ay, but he will not now be pacified: Fabian can scarce hold him yonder.

ANDREW

Plague on't, an I thought he had been valiant and so cunning in fence, I'd have seen him damned ere I'd have challenged him. Let him let the matter slip, and I'll give him my horse, grey Caplet.

TOBY

I'll make the motion: stand here, make a good show on't: this shall end without the perdition of souls.

[Aside] Marry, I'll ride your horse as well as I ride you.

(Re-enter FABIAN and VIOLA.)

[Aside to FABIAN] I have his horse to take up the quarrel: I have persuaded him the youth's a devil.

FABIAN

[Aside to TOBY] He is as horribly conceited of him; and pants and looks pale, as if a bear were at his heels.



'SAVEST THOU THAT HOUSE IS DARK?'